

Couture Corsetry

Finishing Checklist



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The details that are easy to overlook. Check them before you photograph, deliver or present your piece.

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1 · How to use this checklist

Print this guide once per garment and tick each point as you go. If a point is not met, fix it there and then: fixing it later takes twice as long. At the end you will have a record of how you made each piece, which helps you repeat what went well.

Garment	Pattern	Client / purpose	Date

2 · Before sewing: pattern and cutting

- ☐ The printed test square measures 10 × 10 cm (3.94 × 3.94 in).
- ☐ The client's measurements have been compared with the pattern table and the pattern adapted if needed.
- ☐ The toile has been fitted and the changes transferred to the paper pattern.
- ☐ All pieces are cut with the grainline arrow parallel to the selvage.
- ☐ Mirrored pieces are cut in pairs (right and left).
- ☐ Waist and notches marked on every piece, on the wrong side.
- ☐ Outer fabric and coutil basted together in the seam allowance (if used as one layer).

3 · During assembly: panels and seams

- ☐ Every seam starts at the waist notch and the notches match.
- ☐ The waistlines of all the panels sit at the same height.
- ☐ Seams are pressed open before the next one is sewn.
- ☐ No puckers or tucks in the seams (look at the right side, in raking light).
- ☐ Both sides of the corset measure the same at the waist and along the center length.
- ☐ Threads are trimmed close on every finished seam.

4 · Structure: bones, busk and waist tape

- ☐ The busk is centered and its studs go into the loops without forcing.
- ☐ Both sides of the busk are level at the top and bottom.
- ☐ The waist tape is stitched along the waistline, from center to center.
- ☐ The boning channels are the same width all the way along.
- ☐ Each bone is 1 cm ($\frac{3}{8}$ in) shorter than its channel and has protected tips.
- ☐ No bone can be felt when you run your hand over the right side.
- ☐ The flat bones sit next to the eyelets and the busk.

5 · Edges and binding

- ☐ The binding covers the edge at the same width all the way round.
- ☐ On curves, the binding neither pleats nor pulls.
- ☐ The corners at center front and center back are neat and closed.
- ☐ The hand slip-stitching on the inside does not show on the right side.
- ☐ No bone or coutil peeks out at the edge.

6 · Eyelets and lacing

- ☐ The eyelets are the same distance from the edge (as on the pattern) and aligned.
- ☐ Each pair is at the same height on both sides.
- ☐ They are all firmly set: they do not turn or move.
- ☐ The lacing crosses without twisting, with the tightening loops at the waist.
- ☐ With the corset on, the lacing gap is even from top to bottom (not a V).

7 · Inside the garment

- ☐ Allowances trimmed evenly and no loose threads.
- ☐ Lining (if any) without bagging or pulling.

☐ Label or own brand tag sewn where it does not rub the skin.

☐ Modesty panel behind the lacing (if you include one).

8 · Lingerie: elastics, gussets and straps

☐ The elastic is even, with no waves, and 10 % shorter than the edge.

☐ The picot shows evenly all the way round.

☐ The gusset has a cotton lining and no seams show.

☐ The side seams of the briefs or bodysuit match at the top and bottom.

☐ The straps have been length-tested and the adjusters are firmly closed.

☐ The serged seams have no skipped stitches.

9 · Final check before photographing or delivering

☐ Checked against the light: no loose threads, no chalk or pencil marks.

☐ Final press with a pressing cloth (without resting the iron on bones or eyelets).

☐ Tried on the dress form or the client: it closes without forcing and does not dig into the hip when sitting.

☐ Photos of the front, back and details (see Bonus III).

☐ Spare lacing and wear-and-care instructions ready for handover.

Next step

Print this checklist and keep it next to your machine for your next corset. Once you have ticked every point, your piece is ready to photograph with the Photography & Styling guide.